

IB Tier Rules Developer Implementation Guide

Movement Markets Partner Programme

Version 2.0 | Implementation baseline | 11 September 2026

Purpose and implementation decision

This guide defines how the backend and admin UI must calculate IB tiers, account-type eligibility, symbol-level commission, evaluation periods, upgrades, downgrades, one-time bonuses and payouts. The implementation is configuration-driven: tiers, thresholds, eligible account types and individual symbol rates are stored as versioned records rather than hard-coded business logic.

The key rule is fail-closed commission eligibility. A commission is created only when the IB tier, referred trading account type and exact traded symbol all match an active configuration version at the trade close time. An unchecked account type earns no commission for any symbol in that tier.

Implementation summary

Area	Required behaviour
Tier qualification	Automatic upgrade requires volume AND active-trader thresholds.
Account eligibility	Unchecked account type returns no commission for every symbol in that tier.
Symbol rates	One exact symbol per rate row; no instrument or symbol grouping.
Configuration changes	Publish as a new effective-dated version; never recalculate earlier accruals.
Upgrade	Apply prospectively from the evaluation timestamp; upgrades may skip tiers.
Downgrade	Flag when either current-tier threshold fails; apply grace; demote at most one tier per evaluation.
One-time bonus	Create once when a tier first becomes effective; do not repay on re-entry.
Payout	Tier evaluation and payout schedules are independent processes.

1 Programme configuration

Use one evaluation mode and timezone for an entire tier ladder. Mixing Calendar Month and Rolling 30 Days between tiers makes qualification comparisons inconsistent and should be blocked by validation. Tier values below reflect the current product prototype and remain editable by an authorized administrator.

Tier	Minimum volume	Minimum active traders	Bonus	Movement
Associate	0 lots	0	None	Automatic
Partner	500 lots	5	Configured	Automatic

Tier	Minimum volume	Minimum active traders	Bonus	Movement
Senior Partner	1,500 lots	15	\$1,000 example	Automatic
Elite	3,000 lots	30	Configured	Automatic
Director	7,500 lots	60	Configured	Automatic
Managing Partner	15,000 lots	120	Configured or negotiated	Automatic or manual

2 Core data model

The names below are logical entities. Developers may adapt table names to the existing codebase, but the relationships, uniqueness rules and history requirements must be preserved.

Entity	Minimum fields and purpose
ib_programme	id, name, evaluation_mode, timezone, evaluation_time, payout_schedule, active_trader_rule
ib_tier	id, programme_id, name, level_order, minimum_volume, minimum_active_traders, status
ib_tier_version	tier_id, version, effective_from, effective_to, created_by, change_reason
tier_account_type	tier_version_id, account_type_id, is_eligible; unique by tier version and account type
tier_symbol_rate	tier_version_id, account_type_id, symbol_id, rate_per_closed_lot; unique by all four identifiers
ib_tier_assignment	ib_id, tier_id, effective_from, effective_to, source, evaluation_run_id
ib_evaluation_run	id, programme_id, window_start, window_end, run_at, status, idempotency_key
ib_tier_risk	ib_id, tier_id, first_failed_at, consecutive_failed_evaluations, recovered_at, state
commission_ledger	trade_close_event_id, ib_id, tier_version_id, account_type_id, symbol_id, lots, rate, amount, state
tier_bonus_award	ib_id, tier_id, award_type, amount, earned_at, state, paid_at; unique first-achievement award
audit_log	actor, action, entity, before_value, after_value, reason, occurred_at

3 Account type and symbol commission rules

3.1 Eligibility rule

Each tier version stores a set of eligible account-type IDs. The admin UI presents these as checkboxes. If Standard and Pro are checked while Raw Spread and Zero are unchecked, the IB can earn commission only from referred Standard and Pro accounts. Raw Spread and Zero trades must produce no commission ledger entry.

- Unchecked means not eligible. It does not mean a zero-value commission rate.
- The reason ACCOUNT_TYPE_NOT_ELIGIBLE should be recorded in calculation logs for support and audit.
- Unchecking an account type creates a new configuration version with an effective timestamp.
- Trades closed before the effective timestamp keep the prior eligibility and rate. They are not recalculated.
- Trades closed at or after the effective timestamp use the new version and receive no commission for that unchecked account type.
- If an account type is enabled again, rates must be reviewed and explicitly published before commission resumes.

3.2 Exact symbol rates

Store one rate row for each exact symbol and eligible account type. Do not group EURUSD, GBPUSD and USDJPY under Major FX. This allows one symbol to change without affecting another. Resolve symbols through the platform's canonical symbol ID; the displayed code should be normalized to uppercase for administration.

Tier	Account type	Symbol	Rate	Meaning
Senior Partner	Standard	EURUSD	\$9.00	\$9.00 per closed standard lot
Senior Partner	Pro	EURUSD	\$7.50	\$7.50 per closed standard lot
Senior Partner	Standard	XAUUSD	\$13.75	\$13.75 per closed standard lot
Senior Partner	Zero unchecked	XAUUSD	No rate	No commission event is created

3.3 Commission resolution

Run the following lookup whenever eligible closed volume is received:

1. Resolve the referral relationship that was active for the trading account at trade close time.
2. Resolve the IB tier assignment active at trade close time.
3. Resolve the tier configuration version active at trade close time.
4. Check whether the trading account type is eligible in that tier version.
5. Find the rate for the exact canonical symbol ID and account type ID.
6. Calculate commission using decimal arithmetic: closed lots multiplied by rate per closed lot.
7. Post one idempotent ledger entry and retain all input identifiers used in the calculation.

If the account type is unchecked, return ACCOUNT_TYPE_NOT_ELIGIBLE. If no exact symbol rate exists, return RATE_NOT_CONFIGURED. Both outcomes produce no payable commission and must be visible in operational logs.

```

tier_assignment = tier_at(ib_id, trade.closed_at)
version = tier_version_at(tier_assignment.tier_id, trade.closed_at)
if not eligible(version, trade.account_type_id): skip(ACCOUNT_TYPE_NOT_ELIGIBLE)
rate = exact_rate(version, trade.account_type_id, trade.symbol_id)
if rate is missing: skip(RATE_NOT_CONFIGURED)
amount = decimal(trade.closedLots) * decimal(rate)
post_once(trade.close_event_id, amount, version.id)

```

4 Evaluation periods

Evaluation determines the tier; payout scheduling determines when confirmed money is transferred. Keep these as separate settings. A Rolling 30 Days programme may still pay partners monthly.

Mode	Measurement window	Evaluation schedule	Recommended downgrade behaviour
Calendar Month	Previous complete calendar month in programme timezone	First day of the next month, normally 00:05	One full monthly grace cycle, then at most one tier down
Rolling 30 Days	Immediately preceding 30 days ending at run time	Daily, normally 00:05	Require 30 consecutive days below either current-tier requirement
Lifetime	IB approval time through run time	Daily or monthly	Upgrade-only; disable automatic downgrade except reversals or manual compliance action

4.1 Calendar Month

For an evaluation at 00:05 UTC on 1 April, use activity from 00:00 UTC on 1 March up to but excluding 00:00 UTC on 1 April. A qualifying upgrade becomes effective at the 1 April evaluation timestamp. March trades retain the March tier rate.

4.2 Rolling 30 Days

For an evaluation at 00:05 UTC on 11 September, use activity from 00:05 UTC on 12 August up to but excluding 00:05 UTC on 11 September. Recalculate daily. A partner is at risk while either current-tier threshold fails. Demotion occurs only after 30 consecutive days of failure; any successful daily evaluation resets the risk timer.

4.3 Lifetime

Count all eligible activity from IB approval through the evaluation timestamp. Because cumulative totals normally do not decrease, this mode should be upgrade-only. Reversals may correct totals, but automatic downgrade should remain disabled unless the business explicitly adopts a different policy.

4.4 Active trader counting

Count distinct referred client IDs that satisfy the configured active-trader rule within the same evaluation window. The recommended default is at least 1 closed standard lot in the period. Do not count multiple trading accounts belonging to the same client more than once unless the programme explicitly defines account-based counting.

5 Upgrade lifecycle

1. At evaluation time, aggregate eligible volume and distinct active traders for the selected period.
2. Find every active tier for which both minimum requirements are met.
3. Select the highest qualifying tier. Upgrades may skip intermediate tiers.

4. If the selected tier is above the current tier, close the current assignment and create a new effective-dated assignment.
5. Use the new tier only for trades closed at or after the assignment effective time.
6. Create the one-time bonus award only if this is the IB's first effective assignment to that tier.
7. Emit an upgrade event, write an audit record and notify the IB after the transaction commits.

Meeting only one requirement never upgrades the IB. Re-running the same evaluation must not create a second assignment, bonus or notification.

6 Downgrade lifecycle

Downgrade checks use the requirements of the IB's current tier. Missing either volume or active-trader minimum starts or continues the at-risk state. The grace rule depends on the programme evaluation mode.

1. On the first failed evaluation, set state to AT_RISK and store first_failed_at. Keep the current tier and rate.
2. If the IB meets both current-tier requirements during grace, clear the risk state and keep the tier.
3. If failure continues through the configured grace, demote exactly one tier at that evaluation.
4. Close the old assignment and create the lower-tier assignment with the evaluation timestamp as effective_from.
5. Apply the lower rate only to trades closed at or after that timestamp.
6. Do not reverse confirmed commission or claw back a valid bonus because of a normal downgrade.

For Calendar Month, one grace cycle means the first failed monthly evaluation creates the warning and the next monthly evaluation may demote if the failure remains. For Rolling 30 Days, use a 30-consecutive-day failure timer rather than one daily evaluation, which would provide only a one-day grace period.

7 One-time bonus lifecycle

A one-time tier bonus is earned when the tier assignment first becomes effective, not while the IB is still working toward the threshold. Create a unique award for the IB and tier so retries or later re-entry cannot pay it twice.

Event	Required result
First automatic upgrade becomes effective	Create bonus award in Pending state if the tier bonus is greater than zero.
KYC and agreement valid	Release for the next payout run, targeted within 5 business days of tier effective time.
Compliance or payout hold	Keep award Pending; resume when cleared. The service target pauses while blocked.
Downgrade before payment	Keep the valid earned bonus; do not cancel solely because of the downgrade.
IB later returns to same tier	Do not create or pay the bonus again.
Manual tier assignment	Default to no bonus; require an explicit grant_bonus decision and audit reason.
Fraud or confirmed calculation error	Create a separate audited reversal; never delete the original ledger record.

8 Balance and payout mechanics

State	Meaning	Transition
Pending	Commission accrued from eligible closed trades; still subject to allowed corrections	Created trade by trade
Confirmed	Locked commission for a completed payout period	At payout-period close after reconciliation
Paid	Funds transferred and payment reference recorded	After successful payout provider confirmation
Reversed	Separate negative ledger entry correcting an earlier amount	Fraud, reversal or confirmed calculation correction

A rate, tier or account-eligibility change never edits historical ledger rows. Reversals discovered before confirmation reduce Pending. Reversals discovered after confirmation or payment create a separate negative entry that is netted against a later payout according to finance policy.

9 Admin UI requirements

9.1 Tier management

- List tier name, level, requirements, connected account types, configured symbol count, assigned IB count and status.
- Allow add, edit, manage rates, activate or deactivate and delete actions subject to permissions.
- Block deletion while IB assignments reference the tier; require migration to another tier first.
- Show evaluation-mode explanations and change downgrade controls when Lifetime mode is selected.
- Require an effective timestamp and change reason for account eligibility or rate publication.

9.2 Commission editor

- Display account types as eligibility checkboxes and individual symbols as separate rows.
- When an account type is unchecked, hide or disable its rate column and label it No commission.
- State that the change affects future trade closes only and preserves earlier accruals.
- Require a non-negative rate for every displayed symbol under each checked account type.
- Reject duplicate canonical symbol IDs in the same tier version and account type.
- Preview additions, removals and rate changes before publication.

9.3 IB management

- Show identity, KYC, agreement, programme status, current tier, at-risk status and assigned manager.
- Show total and active referred clients, period volume, lifetime volume and tier progress.
- Show Pending, Confirmed and Paid commission, one-time bonus history, payout method and payout holds.
- Show the tier and configuration version used for each commission calculation.
- Provide audited actions for manual tier change, manager assignment, payout hold and suspension.

10 Service behaviour and scheduled processing

Process	Trigger	Idempotency and output
Commission accrual	Eligible trade close event	Unique trade close event ID; one ledger result or one skip reason
Tier evaluation	Monthly or daily schedule	Unique programme plus window end; assignments, risk state and bonus in one transaction
Payout confirmation	Payout period close	Unique programme plus payout period; Pending to Confirmed after reconciliation
Payment	Approved payout run	Unique payout instruction; record provider reference before marking Paid
Configuration publish	Authorized admin action	Immutable version, effective timestamp, actor and change reason

Scheduled jobs must use database locking or an equivalent single-run mechanism. A retry after partial failure must resume safely without creating duplicate tier assignments, bonuses, commission ledger entries or notifications.

11 Required validation

- Tier level order is unique within a programme and thresholds do not decrease as levels rise.
- All tiers in one ladder use the same evaluation mode, timezone and active-trader definition.
- At least one account type must be eligible before a tier rate configuration can be published.
- Rates use decimal storage, never binary floating point, and cannot be negative.
- Every symbol row references a canonical tradable symbol ID; duplicate rows are rejected.
- `effective_from` cannot overlap another active version for the same tier.
- A tier cannot be deleted while current or historical assignments require its identity.
- Manual overrides require actor, reason and timestamp and never overwrite historical records.

12 Acceptance test scenarios

Scenario	Expected result
Standard checked, EURUSD rate exists	Eligible close creates commission using the exact Standard and EURUSD rate.
Zero unchecked, XAUUSD rate remains in an older version	No new commission; log <code>ACCOUNT_TYPE_NOT_ELIGIBLE</code> .
Account checked but symbol missing	No commission; log <code>RATE_NOT_CONFIGURED</code> and surface an operational alert.
Eligibility is unpublished or future-dated	Continue using the currently effective configuration.
Eligibility becomes effective while a trade is open	Use eligibility at close time; an after-effective close uses the new rule.

Scenario	Expected result
Both next-tier requirements met	Upgrade at evaluation time and use the new rate prospectively.
Only volume requirement met	Do not upgrade.
First current-tier failure in Calendar Month	Set AT_RISK; keep current tier for the grace cycle.
Second consecutive monthly failure	Demote one tier at the second evaluation.
Rolling partner recovers before 30 days	Clear risk timer and keep current tier.
First entry to a bonus tier	Create one Pending bonus award when the tier becomes effective.
Downgrade then re-entry to the same tier	Do not create a second one-time bonus.
Evaluation job is retried	No duplicate assignment, bonus, ledger entry or notification.
Rate change after prior commission accrued	Past amount remains unchanged; new closes use the new version.

13 Developer completion checklist

- Effective-dated tier and rate configuration is implemented.
- Account-type eligibility is checked before symbol-rate lookup.
- Individual symbol rates are used with no grouping fallback.
- Calendar Month, Rolling 30 Days and Lifetime windows have timezone-safe automated tests.
- Upgrade, risk, recovery and one-tier downgrade transitions are idempotent.
- One-time bonus uniqueness and payout-hold behaviour are tested.
- Commission, bonus, configuration and manual-action audit records are queryable by support staff.
- Admin UI warnings match backend enforcement.
- Historical commission is never silently recalculated after a configuration change.

14 Governing implementation rule

For every trade close, the system must use the IB tier, tier configuration, account-type eligibility and exact symbol rate that were effective at that close time. Tier upgrades, downgrades and configuration publications are prospective. One-time bonuses are awarded once when a tier first becomes effective, and all automated or manual changes remain auditable and safe to retry.